STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-4130	
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **03/06/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT TIRE DEFLATION DEVICES	CROSS REFERENCE G-6100 USE OF FORCE/FORCE CONTINUUM P-4100 PURSUITS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for deploying tire deflation devices.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office recognizes the use of tire deflation devices as an acceptable method for terminating a vehicular pursuit. Tire deflation devices are designed to deflate tires on a moving vehicle in a manner that avoids a catastrophic tire failure and ensures the safest possible means of reducing the mobility of a vehicle.

III. Procedures:

A. Tire Deflation Device-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. A deputy shall only deploy a tire deflation device if given permission by a shift supervisor or command officer. Each deputy who intends to deploy a tire deflation device must receive permission from a patrol supervisor or a commander. Permission granted to one deputy doesn't imply the other deputies also have approval to deploy a tire deflation device.

2. No deputy shall deploy a tire deflation device unless he/she has received training in the proper procedures to do so.

3. The deputy shall respond to a location ahead of the projected path of the pursuit and prepare to deploy the tire deflation device.

4. The deputy shall advise Communications of the location of the intended deployment and ensure that all units involved in the pursuit are aware of the location and intended deployment.

5. Deputies shall not overtake or attempt to pass a fleeing vehicle to deploy a tire deflation device unless speeds and traffic conditions allow this to be accomplished in a safe manner.

6. Tire deflation devices shall not be dropped or thrown from moving vehicles.

7. The tire deflation device shall not be used in locations which would increase the risk of injury to the suspect or others. These locations may include:

a) Roadways with steep embankments.
b) Curves.
c) Bridges.
d) Locations where the safety of on-coming traffic cannot be reasonably assured.

8. Deployment locations shall have adequate sight lines in all directions to ensure the deploying deputy is able to observe and react to the pursuit and other traffic.

9. The primary pursuit unit shall coordinate with the deploying deputy. If possible, the primary unit shall give the deploying deputy ample warning when to deploy the tire deflation device

10. The deploying deputy shall park his or her patrol unit in such a manner as to not interfere with the path of the violator. If possible, the deploying deputy shall use the patrol unit to shield the tire deflation device prior to deployment. The deploying deputy shall activate his or her emergency lights to prevent non-involved vehicles from striking the patrol unit.

11. If possible, the deploying deputy shall not stand directly behind the patrol unit to prevent injury if the suspect's vehicle strikes the patrol unit, and he or she shall seek cover after deployment to avoid being struck by the tire deflation system.

12. Deputies shall deploy the tire deflation device in the manner prescribed by the manufacturer. Deputies shall receive initial training in the deployment methods and shall receive periodic update training.

13. The deputy deploying the tire deflation device shall be responsible for immediately securing the device after the suspect has passed. This shall include searching the immediate area for any spikes which may have become detached.

14. The primary pursuit unit shall allow enough distance between himself or herself and the pursued vehicle to provide the deploying deputy the time necessary to remove the tire deflation system from the roadway.

15. The deploying deputy shall be responsible for repairing and replacing any spikes in the device. Replacement equipment shall be located in the Road Patrol Storage Room.

16. Tire deflation devices shall only be deployed for other departments if the following criteria are met:

a) The initiating department requests assistance from our office.

b) Each deputy who intends to deploy a tire deflation device must receive permission from a patrol supervisor or a commander. Permission granted to one deputy doesn't imply the other deputies also have approval to deploy a tire deflation device.

c) The pursuit meets the criteria listed in the "Justification" section of our pursuit policy (P-4100). A patrol supervisor or a commander may override this requirement.

17. Tire deflation devices shall not be used on the following vehicles:

a) Motorcycles (unless deadly force is justified, see G-6100 Use of Force).
b) Any vehicle transporting a hazardous material.
c) Any passenger bus or van transporting passengers.
d) Any vehicle that would pose an unusual hazard to innocent persons.

18. Any deputy deploying a tire deflation device shall complete a supplemental report using the report number from the original pursuit incident report. If the tire deflation device was deployed for another agency, the deputy shall obtain a report number and complete an incident report.

B. Tire Deflation Device-Command Officer or Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. The command officer or shift supervisor shall authorize the use of a tire deflation device based on available information and the need to apprehend the suspect.

2. After deployment, the shift supervisor shall review all reports and complete a findings report or incident review regarding the deployment of the tire deflation device. This review may be in conjunction with the pursuit review as required in P-4100 Pursuits. The findings report or incident review shall be submitted to the Road Patrol Commander for review.